

CONQUERING CHALLENGES!

WE NEED MORE WOMEN IN TECH. OF THAT THERE'S NO DOUBT. PROMINENT TECHIE WOMEN – SPANNING FROM THE BIGGEST TECH COMPANIES TO PROMISING TECH STARTUPS – WE DISCUSS HOW THAT CAN BE ACHIEVED AS WE TALK TO PROMINENT LEADERS IN THE FIELD OF TECHNOLOGY.

BY JAYESH SHINDE

Technology hasn't been touched by pioneering women in the past alone. Modern day female role models continue to inspire all of us (not just girls) to break barriers, reach for the stars, push the frontiers of technology and boundaries of the status quo further than ever before. By doing this, not only are they empowering themselves but a whole generation of Indians who are waiting in the wings. And possibly many more people around the world.

When it comes to girls or women techies, we don't have enough of them to begin with, and more's the pity. Google claims that less than one per cent of girls study Computer Science in the US. According to the search giant, girls start out with a love for science and technology

up until middle school (74 per cent), before losing it somewhere along the way. By college, only 0.3 per cent girls actually plan to study Computer Science. This is a huge cause for concern, especially because jobs in Computer Science are slated to pay substantially more than the average. Encouragement from adults and peers is the number one contributor to a girl's decision to pursue academics and a career in Computer Science. As a result of all this, technology and humanity at large is suffering and held back from a faster rate of overall progress.

If America's struggling with the problem of underrepresentation of women in technology, it's safe to assume that we too have a lot of work to do to empower women here in India.

We spoke to a number of women leaders and role models from India – all of whom are geeks and techies in their own right – to get a sense of the awareness levels among the masses when it comes to women's contribution in technology, how to get more girls into tech-related careers, and other relevant questions.

WOMEN TECH, IS IT POPULAR?

As far as awareness levels go, we wanted to understand what senior women technology executives in technology companies thought of the awareness levels among the masses regarding the role played by women in furthering technological advances.

"Women are making a mark in every industry today irrespective of which field